



YOU ARE PLAYING

Emerson Quill

*Reporter, The Larkhaven Ledger**“Every story in Larkhaven ends up in the Ledger eventually.”*

FOR EMERSON QUILL'S EYES ONLY

Do not share this booklet. Do not read ahead of the rounds.

COSTUME IDEA

A trench coat, a press card tucked into the hat band, a notebook and a pencil.

WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS ABOUT YOU

Chief (and only) reporter for *The Larkhaven Ledger*. Emerson came tonight to cover Ellis's big announcement for the New Year's Day edition.

- ◆ **Ellis Pendleworth:** the subject of your next big story
- ◆ **Parker Brightwell:** the mayor, and your favourite source of quotes
- ◆ **Devon Ashby:** the planner who keeps shooing you away from the guests

PAGE 2

Before the game

Read before guests arrive

PAGE 3

Rounds 1 · 2

Read each only when told

PAGE 4

Round 3 · Notes

Suspects & your theories

Turn the page only when you are ready to begin. Detective Rowan Hale will tell you when to read each round.



Before the game



THE TRUTH

You are innocent. You did not harm Ellis. But you do have something to hide, so tonight you will look suspicious.

Your background

You have written for the Ledger for ten years: lost cats, bake sales, the year the river flooded. Tonight's announcement was meant to be your front page.

YOUR SECRET

You are working on a scandal: rumours that Old Lark was really built by an apprentice, not by a Pendleworth. Ellis heard about it last week and threatened to sue the Ledger. Tonight you planned to corner Ellis for a quote, so you sat on the corridor bench outside the workshop from 9:45 until 10:28.

Your story tonight

At first, say you were “around” all evening, writing. You never went into the workshop, not once.

Your goals tonight

- ◆ Get the real story, whatever it turns out to be
- ◆ Keep your scandal draft secret until you are sure of it
- ◆ Be the first to name the guilty party (what a scoop!)

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

- ◆ Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2; page 4 holds Round 3. Read each round **only when Detective Rowan Hale announces it**.
- ◆ Print this booklet **single-sided** so later rounds never show through. You can also cut along the dashed line on page 3 and hand out the rounds one at a time.
- ◆ Share what your round tells you to share. Everything on this page stays secret unless a round says otherwise.

Rounds 1 and 2



✦ Round 1



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 1.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ You have sat through plenty of court cases. You know the difference between gossip and evidence.
- ◆ At 9:47 you saw Reese Calloway come out of the workshop muttering “Stubborn old fool.”
- ◆ Between 10:00 and 10:27, exactly one person went into the workshop from the corridor. Don’t say who yet: you are “checking your notes”.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Reese Calloway** what they were doing in the workshop before 9:47.
- ◆ Ask **Parker Brightwell** for a quote on Old Lark’s future.

YOUR TASK

Interview three guests “for the Ledger” and write down one surprising thing each of them says.

----- ✂ FOLD OR CUT HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE -----

✦ Round 2



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 2.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Name them now: at 10:05 Devon Ashby carried a single blue mug into the workshop. Through the door you heard Ellis say, “Thank you, Devon, you’re a treasure.”
- ◆ Devon came out at 10:20, empty-handed, and walked quickly towards the kitchen.
- ◆ Avery Vale passed you at 9:54 on the way to the workshop and the tower stairs.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** why they spent fifteen minutes in the workshop.
- ◆ Ask **Avery Vale** how Ellis seemed at 9:56.

YOUR TASK

Compare your times with the kitchen order slip (E6) and read both out to the room.

Round 3 and notes



✦ Round 3



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 3.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ If your scandal story comes up, admit it. A lawsuit is bad news, but a reporter needs Ellis alive to get a quote.
- ◆ You never set foot in the workshop. Avery found you on the bench, pencil in hand, at 10:28.
- ◆ Your notebook shows nobody else came in from the corridor between 10:00 and 10:27.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Harper Lune** what Ellis told them at 9:00.
- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** who knows the code to the gala supply crate.

YOUR TASK

Write tomorrow's front-page headline about the case and read it aloud before the ballots (a hint, no names!).

Notes

Suspects at a glance

Avery Vale · Apprentice Clockmaker

Reese Calloway · Rival Watchmaker from the City

Harper Lune · The Clockmaker's Long-Lost Relative

Kit Sterling · Antique Dealer

Rory Penhallow · Keeper of the Clock Tower

Dakota Fenwick · Fireworks Master

Parker Brightwell · Mayor of Larkhaven

Emerson Quill · Reporter, The Larkhaven Ledger

Devon Ashby · Gala Party Planner

Sage Whitfield · Gala Pianist & Bandleader

Blair Okafor · Town Historian

Marley Ashgrove · Society Photographer